

“Speak Less, Say More Branching Scenario”

1) SCENARIO CHARTER

Problem Statement

“I speak, but I’m not sure people hear me — or remember what I said.” In fast-paced, multicultural, digital-first workplaces, longer messages are harder to follow, easier to misinterpret, and less likely to stick. The scenario helps learners **say less with more purpose** so that when they speak, they are heard.

Learning Objectives

- **Strip away noise** and **frontload** what matters most.
- **Remove hedging/filler** (e.g., “I just...,” “maybe...,” “I think...”) to strengthen clarity and confidence.
- **Adjust for cultural fluency** so messages are understandable across diverse audiences (recognize differences in directness/indirectness).
- Apply **emotional intelligence**: self-awareness (notice over-explaining), self-regulation (resist adding more), social awareness (adapt to audience).

Success Signals

- The **main idea is clear in the first line** (frontloaded).
- **Hedging/filler** language is **removed**.
- The message is **trimmed** (e.g., **12-word version** is feasible).
- Someone from a **different cultural background** can understand the message without extra explanation.

Context

- **Ava** (protagonist): Mid-level project specialist who tends to over-explain under pressure.
 - **Samir** (manager; Middle Eastern background): Time-pressed; expects clear, frontloaded updates.
 - **Jordan** (Canada): Values brevity; disengages when messages ramble.
 - **Emi** (Japan): Prefers concise, structured messages to avoid ambiguity.
- What happens:** During a hybrid meeting, Ava updates the team on an onboarding workflow issue. Across **three decision points**, Ava must (1) **trim & frontload** her message, (2) **remove hedging** when giving a recommendation, and (3) **state concise next steps** that work across cultural expectations. Visible reactions show consequences.
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2) FULL BRANCHING SCRIPT WITH DECISIONS

(Slides are listed in delivery order for Rise/Storyline. Use one consistent font; keep on-screen lines short.)



SLIDE 0 — INTRODUCTION (SPARK)

Title: Speak Less, Say More

Text: Use language for clarity and impact.

Narration:

“In a fast-paced, multicultural workplace, more words can mean less clarity. In this scenario, you’ll practice saying less—with greater purpose.”

Navigation: Continue → Decision 1



DECISION POINT 1 — TRIM & FRONTLOAD

SLIDE D1 — Decision Point 1

Title: Decision 1 — Trim & Frontload

Prompt:

Samir asks: “**What’s the status on onboarding?**”

You tend to over-explain. How do you begin?

Options:

- A. “**Main point first:** onboarding is delayed due to two missing approvals.”
- B. “We’ve been reviewing onboarding, and... the main issue is missing approvals.”
- C. “We restarted onboarding because new hires were overwhelmed, and then...”

Navigation:

Select Option → Consequence

OPTION A — BEST

SLIDE D1-A-C — Consequence

Dialogue Outcome: Samir relaxes; Jordan nods; Emi takes notes immediately.

Why: Frontloading + ≈12-word clarity improves comprehension.

SLIDE D1-A-F — Feedback

Correct.

Explanation: Clear, frontloaded messages reduce cognitive load and support cross-cultural clarity.

Reflection Prompt: “What did trimming reveal as the true message?”

Cultural Insight: Direct upfront clarity helps non-native speakers.

Relationship Note: Builds trust with your manager.

Navigation: Continue → Decision 2

OPTION B — NEUTRAL

SLIDE D1-B-C — Consequence

Outcome: Samir redirects; Emi hesitates.

Why: Delayed point → listener effort increases.

SLIDE D1-B-F — Feedback

Partially Correct.

Explanation: Trimming helped, but burying the main idea dilutes clarity.

Reflection Prompt: “What happens when people must wait for the main point?”

Cultural Insight: Different expectations for directness can increase misinterpretation.

Relationship Note: Adds small friction with manager.

Navigation: Continue → Decision 2

OPTION C — POOR

SLIDE D1-C-C — Consequence

Outcome: Samir checks watch; Jordan disengages; Emi confused.

Why: Long explanations = cognitive overload.

SLIDE D1-C-F — Feedback

Incorrect.

Explanation: Over-explaining weakens impact. Clarity drops in multicultural teams.

Reflection Prompt: “When do you talk more because you feel unheard?”

Cultural Insight: Overload makes communication harder for non-native speakers.

Relationship Note: Lowers perceived clarity.

Navigation: Continue → Decision 2

DECISION POINT 2 — REMOVE HEDGING

SLIDE D2 — Decision Point 2

Title: Decision 2 — Remove Hedging

Prompt:

Samir asks: “**What do you recommend?**”

You often hedge when you’re unsure.

Options:

A. “**I recommend** we streamline the review steps to avoid delays.”

B. “**I think maybe** we could streamline some review steps?”

C. “**I’m not sure if this makes sense**, but maybe we could consider...”

Navigation: Select Option → Consequence

OPTION A — BEST

SLIDE D2-A-C — Consequence

Outcome: Samir nods; Jordan impressed; Emi confident in next steps.

SLIDE D2-A-F — Feedback

Correct.

Why: Removing hedging strengthens clarity and shows confidence.

Reflection: “Which hedging phrase do you rely on?”

Cultural Insight: Hedging forces others to decode meaning.

Relationship Note: Builds credibility.

Navigation: Continue → Decision 3

OPTION B — NEUTRAL

SLIDE D2-B-C — Consequence

Outcome: Samir unsure; Emi uncertain; Jordan asks clarifying questions.

SLIDE D2-B-F — Feedback

Partially Correct.

Why: Light hedging = ambiguous intent.

Reflection: “How confident does this sound?”

Cultural Insight: Politeness may create confusion across cultures.

Relationship Note: Slows decision-making.

Navigation: Continue → Decision 3

OPTION C — POOR

SLIDE D2-C-C — Consequence

Outcome: Manager frustrated; colleagues confused.

SLIDE D2-C-F — Feedback

Incorrect.

Why: Heavy hedging dilutes message and signals uncertainty.

Reflection: “When do you hedge most?”

Cultural Insight: Can be misread as incompetence.

Relationship Note: Erodes trust.

Navigation: Continue → Decision 3



SLIDE D3 — Decision Point 3

Title: Decision 3 — Cultural Fluency & Clear Next Steps

Prompt:

Team needs alignment on roles and timing. Cultural expectations differ.

Options:

A. “**Next step:** Emi reviews Thursday; Jordan and I finalize Friday.”

B. “Maybe we can work on it **sometime this week?**”

C. “Emi might start, or Jordan, or both—and we could also...”

Navigation: Select Option → Consequence

OPTION A — BEST

SLIDE D3-A-C — Consequence

Outcome: Emi relieved; Jordan aligned; Samir confident.

SLIDE D3-A-F — Feedback

Correct.

Why: Clear steps reduce “cultural decoding load.”

Reflection: “How did specificity help?”

Cultural Insight: Clarity prevents misinterpretation across cultures.

Relationship Note: Builds reliability.

Navigation: Continue → Conclusion

OPTION B — NEUTRAL

SLIDE D3-B-C — Consequence

Outcome: Confusion about timing; stalled alignment.

SLIDE D3-B-F — Feedback

Partially Correct.

Why: Vague timing invites varied interpretations.

Reflection: “Have vague messages caused delays for you?”

Cultural Insight: Indirectness differs widely across cultures.

Relationship Note: Creates friction.

Navigation: Continue → Conclusion

OPTION C — POOR

SLIDE D3-C-C — Consequence

Outcome: Overload; meeting derails.

SLIDE D3-C-F — Feedback

Incorrect.

Why: Too much information overwhelms listeners.

Reflection: “Which detail could you remove?”

Cultural Insight: Over-explaining is burdensome for non-native speakers.

Relationship Note: Reduces clarity and confidence.

Navigation: Continue → Conclusion

CONCLUSION (STRETCH)

Takeaways:

- Trim to essentials
- Frontload message
- Remove hedging
- Use clear steps
- Communicate inclusively

Action Challenge:

“Within **48 hours**, send one email/meeting update **cut in half**: use a **12-word main point**, remove hedging, and check for cross-cultural clarity,” with:

Trim → Translate → Impact Checklist.”

Narration: “In multicultural teams, brevity isn’t bluntness—it’s clarity. **Speak less, say more** so people understand and act.”

Navigation: Continue → SCORM Completion

3) CONSEQUENCE MATRIX (Quick Reference)

Decision	A (Best)	B (Neutral)	C (Poor)
D1 Trim & Frontload	12-word, frontloaded message → Team aligns	Trimmed but point late → Manager redirects	Long backstory → Disengagement/overload [[03_Templat...nning.docx
D2 Remove Hedging	Clear recommendation; no hedging → Fast alignment	Light hedging → Some uncertainty	Heavy hedging → Confusion & frustration [[03_Templat...nning.docx
D3 Cultural Fluency	Concrete steps & dates → Cross-cultural clarity	Vague timing → Mixed interpretations	Over-detailed plan → Overwhelm; derail [[03_Templat...nning.docx

4) VARIABLES & SCORING (for SCORM)

Tracking Variables (Storyline block inside Rise)

decision1_choice // "A", "B", or "C"

decision2_choice // "A", "B", or "C"

decision3_choice // "A", "B", or "C"

total_score // number; initialize to 0

Scoring Logic

On D1 submit:

if A → total_score += 10

if B → total_score += 5

if C → total_score += 0

set decision1_choice accordingly

On D2 submit:

same pattern; set decision2_choice

On D3 submit:

same pattern; set decision3_choice

Completion:

if total_score >= 20 → Set status Passed

else → Set status Failed

JSON-like Spec (for LMS developers)

```
{"variables": {  
    "decision1_choice": "A|B|C",  
    "decision2_choice": "A|B|C",  
    "decision3_choice": "A|B|C",  
    "total_score": 0},
```

```
"scoringRules": { "A": 10, "B": 5, "C": 0 },  
  
"passingScore": 20,  
  
"completionLogic": "total_score >= 20 ? Passed : Failed"}  
..
```

Completion Trigger in Rise 360

- Place the scoring logic in the **final Storyline slide** and send **Passed/Failed** to Rise.
- If using a **completion variable** instead, set `completion_status = "complete"` when the end screen is reached (in addition to score).

(Appendix) One-screen ASCII Visual Map for Developers

(Optional quick reference to mirror the logic in Storyline.)

START → D1 Trim+Frontload → {A1,B1,C1}

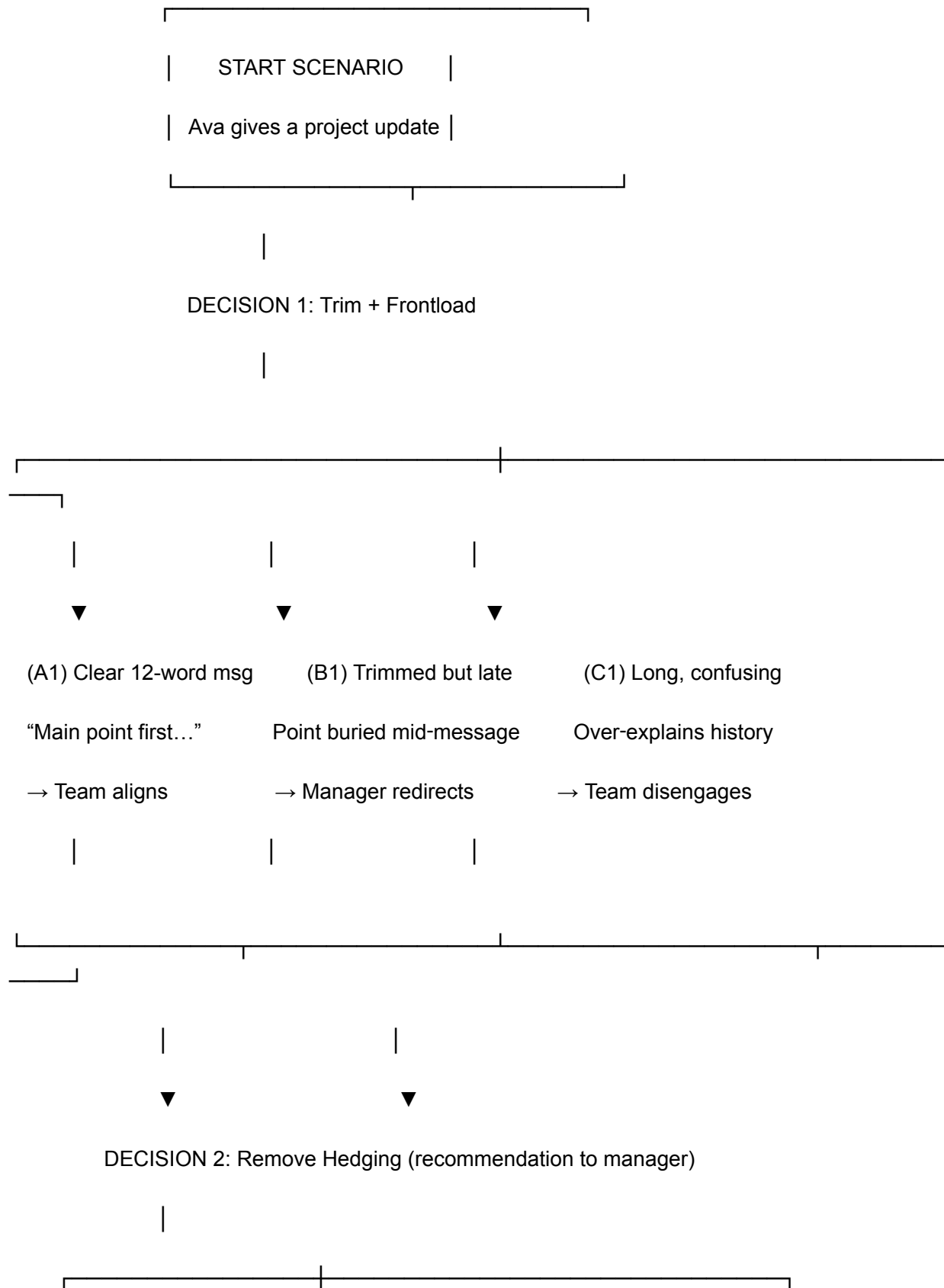
A1/B1/C1 → D2 Remove Hedging → {A2,B2,C2}

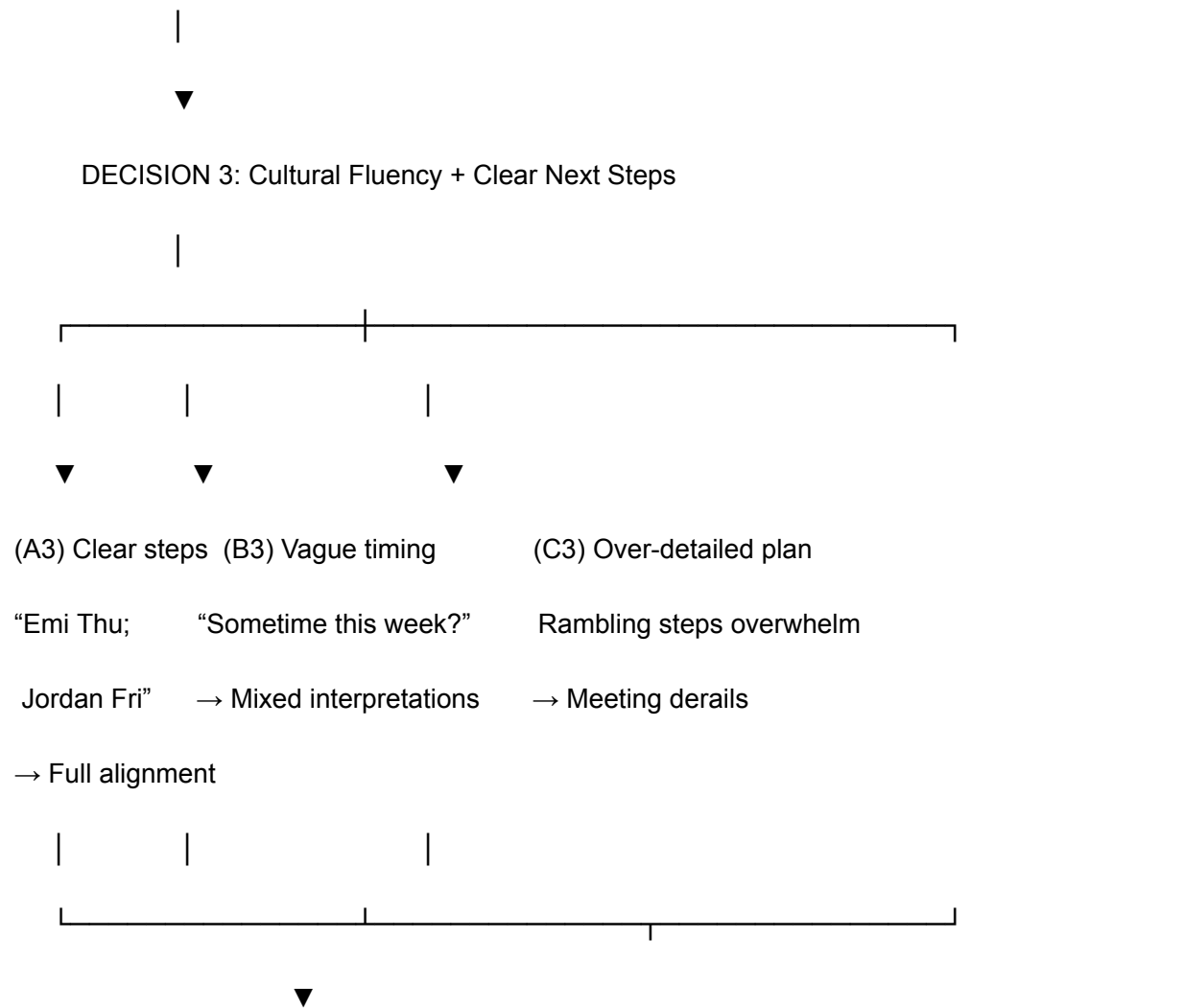
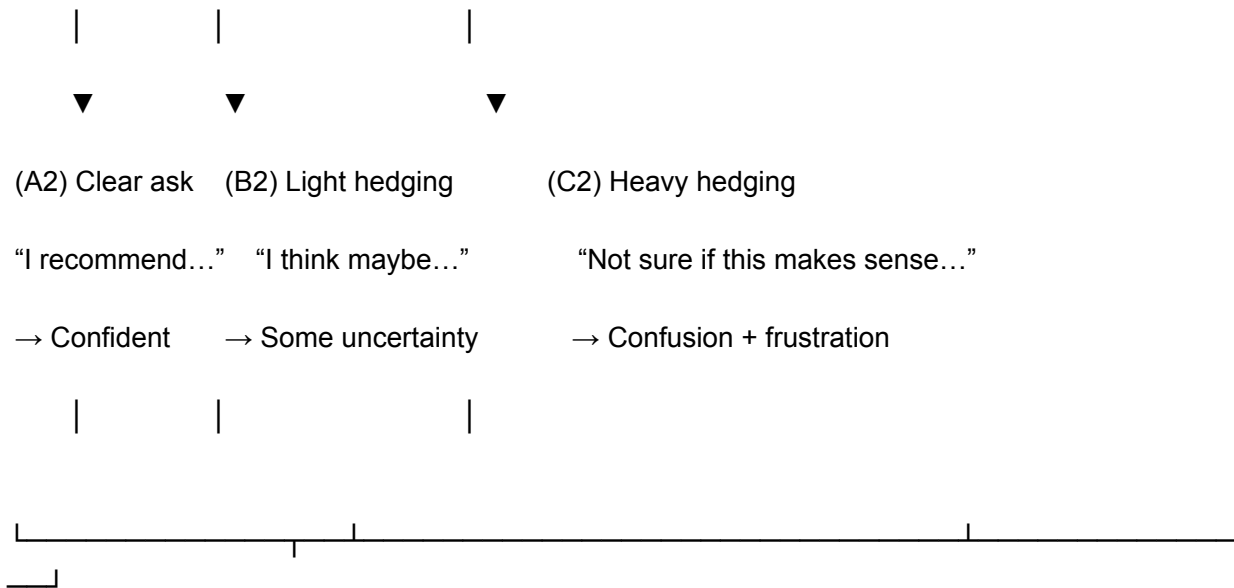
A2/B2/C2 → D3 Cultural Fluency → {A3,B3,C3}

→ SCORM Scoring (A=10, B=5, C=0) → Pass if total_score ≥ 20

Alignment Notes

- All behaviors and feedback are taken from the PDF: **frontload main idea**, **12-word trim**, **remove hedging**, and **make clarity culturally inclusive**; EI skills include **self-awareness**, **self-regulation**, **social awareness**.
- Packaging follows your preferred storyboard flow; if you want a Page/Canvas version for side-by-side editing, say **“Create Page version”** and I’ll format this into a development Page.





SCORM SCORING

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A = 10 pts | B = 5 pts | C = 0 pts

|

total_score = sum

Passing = 20 / 30 points

|



END OF SCENARIO